

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical property law, client care and case management experience gained at Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner (Real Estate Disputes), Citizens Advice East Berkshire and Adobe. Skilled in supporting solicitors and conveyancers across concurrent matters: maintaining organised files, preparing bundles and court materials, drafting correspondence, tracking deadlines and communicating clearly with clients. Attentive to detail and comfortable working accurately under pressure in a collaborative environment.

EDUCATION

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| Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit
Queen Mary University of London | Sept 2024 – Oct 2025 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Modules included dispute resolution procedure, evidence analysis and legal research• Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions — Distinction, 75% | |
| Law LLB — 2:1
University College London | Sept 2020 – June 2024 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Modules included Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law and Alternative Dispute Resolution | |
| International Foundation Programme — Law and International Relations
King's College London | Sept 2019 – June 2020 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree) | |

EXPERIENCE

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| Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London
Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes | Feb 2024 – Aug 2024 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Supported solicitors and partners across residential and commercial property matters including leasehold disputes, landlord and tenant issues, easements and rights of light• Prepared electronic hearing bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and other court materials• Handled court filings, hearing arrangements, matter opening and closure, and deadline tracking across several concurrent files• Maintained matter records and organised large volumes of confidential documents using iManage• Conducted legal and factual research and prepared client notes to keep matters progressing efficiently | |
| Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London
Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration | Aug 2023 – Feb 2024 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial• Drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; amended sections of the Claimant's memorial under supervision• Became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a significant deadline — coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time submission• Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines; liaised with the client on required documents• Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor | |
| Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead
Legal Adviser | July 2026 – Present |

- Manages a caseload spanning housing, debt, welfare benefits, employment, family and consumer matters — taking detailed client instructions, establishing chronologies and identifying key issues
- Drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, and maintains accurate confidential case records to deadlines
- Advises clients on procedural requirements and options, translating complex rules into clear, practical guidance — including for vulnerable individuals
- Assesses eligibility against statutory criteria, identifies evidential gaps and researches complex points to progress matters

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border personal data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

Q-Legal · Remote

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations; identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice; coordinated with client and supervising solicitor to meet deadline

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: iManage; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling; document review; case management and time-recording systems; legal and commercial research; concise report and correspondence writing

Case and evidence management: Hearing bundle preparation, matter file organisation, procedural deadline tracking, evidence review, document scheduling, court filing